Albert Li

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Education

University of British Columbia — Vancouver, BC
Bachelor of Arts, Major in Psychology — *Sep. 2023 – May 2027 (Expected)*
Psychology GPA: 4.33/4.33 Overall GPA: 4.18/4.33

Academic Awards & Honours

Trek Excellence Scholarship — 2026
University of British Columbia

Quinn Research Travel Grant — 2026
University of British Columbia

SPP Travel Award — 2026
Society for Philosophy & Psychology

Dean's Scholar — 2024 – Present
University of British Columbia

Conference Presentations

1. Li, A. Z. K., Alford-Duguid, D., & Ongchoco, J. D. K. (2026). Shadows as derivative individuals. Talk given at the annual meeting of the *Society for Philosophy & Psychology*, 6/19/26, Baltimore, MD, USA.

2. Li, A. Z. K., Alford-Duguid, D., & Ongchoco, J. D. K. (2026). When two become one: A "same-object advantage" that spans across shadows and their casting objects. Talk given at the annual meeting of the *Vision Sciences Society*, 5/16/26, St. Pete Beach, FL, USA.

Research Experience

UBC Perception & Cognition Lab — Vancouver, BC
Research Assistant — PI: Dr. Joan Ongchoco — *August 2025 – Present*

- Developed a first-author research program with Dr. Joan Ongchoco and Dr. Dominic Alford-Duguid (UBC Philosophy), investigating whether and how shadows are bound to their casting objects in visual processing.
- Ran 35 discovery experiments, eight with statistically significant results, and completed five preregistered replications.
- Created 1,600+ stimulus images from 40 rendered 3D scenes and collected behavioural data from 4,000 participant sessions.

UBC Social Cognition & Emotion Lab — Vancouver, BC
Directed Studies Student — PI: Dr. Elizabeth Dunn — *August 2026 – Present*

- Led two studies examining how AI feedback influenced romantic conflict resolution and how AI-generated versus self-written apologies affected apology use.
- Interviewed prospective research assistants, trained a team of eight, and supervised their data collection.
- Recruited and screened 2,000+ participants for the two studies, managed data collection, and conducted systematic data quality checks.

UBC Visual Cognition Lab — Vancouver, BC
Project Lead — PI: Dr. Ronald Rensink — *March 2025 – Present*

- Led an undergraduate research team investigating how dot size, shape, luminance, and colour affected perceived correlation in scatterplots.
- Completed six experiments by coordinating study deployment and participant recruitment, assigning tasks, and tracking milestones.
- Developed checklists and training materials to standardize data collection and documentation.

Research Workshop

CVR Vision Science Summer School June 2026
Centre for Vision Research, York University *Toronto, ON*

- Selected as one of 18 students from 170 applicants for a fully funded, five-day residential program in vision science.
- Attended lectures covering human visual perception, visual neuroscience, computer vision, machine learning, and disorders of vision.
- Completed hands-on, tutorial-style research projects; participated in panel discussions on scientific careers and the use of AI as explicit, testable models of brain computation.

Leadership and Activities

Sense Ability Pediatric Occupational Therapy Vancouver, BC
Behaviour Interventionist *November 2024 – Present*

- Provided one-on-one behavioural interventions to children with Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) using Applied Behaviour Analysis (ABA) techniques.
- Collected and recorded data on children's progress and behaviours to assist in the modification of individualized intervention strategies.

UBC Centre for Student Development & Leadership Vancouver, BC
Senior Orientation Leader *August 2026 – September 2026*

- Led a team of 19 Orientation Leaders who collectively supported 245 first-year students.
- Trained and supported Orientation Leaders, focusing on leadership development, effective communication, teamwork, and problem-solving.

Orientation Leader *August 2025 – September 2025*

- Provided first-year students with support, community-building, and timely resource referrals to aid their transition to university.
- Supported engaging learning environments by leading icebreakers and designing challenges for a learning community of 36 students.

UBC Recreation Vancouver, BC
Facility Staff *May 2025 – September 2025*

- Supported day-to-day gym operations across UBC's three recreation centres, including facility supervision and front-line patron assistance.
- Assisted gym users with equipment-use questions, facility policies, and gym etiquette to help maintain a safe, welcoming, and inclusive recreation environment.

BC Association for Advancing Communications Vancouver, BC
Camp Leader *July 2025*

- Worked one-on-one with a child with ASD who communicated using a TouchChat AAC (Augmentative and Alternative Communication) device, modeling language and supporting communication during daily activities.
- Collaborated with speech-language pathologists, educators, and families to implement AAC strategies that fostered the child's autonomy, literacy, and social connection.

Canada's Wonderland Vaughan, ON
Food and Beverage Supervisor / Bar Supervisor *July 2022 – August 2024*

- Led teams of 20+ associates across high-volume restaurants and bars at Canada's largest amusement park, coaching staff to strengthen service quality and teamwork.

Elections Canada Toronto, ON
Registration Officer *September 2021*

- Welcomed voters and guided them through the registration and voting process during the 2021 Canadian Federal Election.

Technical Skills

Online Experiments: jsPsych, Qualtrics, Prolific
Programming: JavaScript, HTML, CSS
Data Analysis: R, SPSS, Excel
Stimulus Design: Blender, Adobe Photoshop
Relevant Coursework Outside Psychology: CPSC 110: Systematic Program Design, CPSC 121: Models of Computation, CPSC 210: Software Construction, PHIL 220: Symbolic Logic